

Séminaire de l'UQAM pour les étudiants en actuariat/statistique

Extreme Value Analysis based on Blockwise Top-Two Order Statistics

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joint work with Axel Bücher¹

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Why Extreme Value Statistics?



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The art of extrapolation beyond the limits of observation.

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- standard statistics fail $\rightsquigarrow$ necessity to **extrapolate 'into the extremes'**
- two paradigms:
 - **Block Maxima**
 - **Peak over Threshold**

- Take (annual/seasonal) block maxima M_n

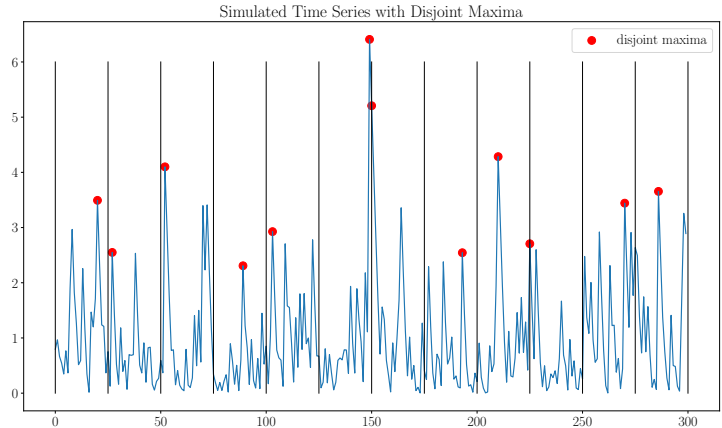


Figure 1: Sample of Disjoint Blockmaxima

Extreme Value Statistics: Block Maxima Modeling

- Take (annual/seasonal) block maxima M_n
- they follow a Generalized Extreme Value Distribution (GEV)
- $M_n \sim \text{GEV}(\gamma, \mu, \sigma)$

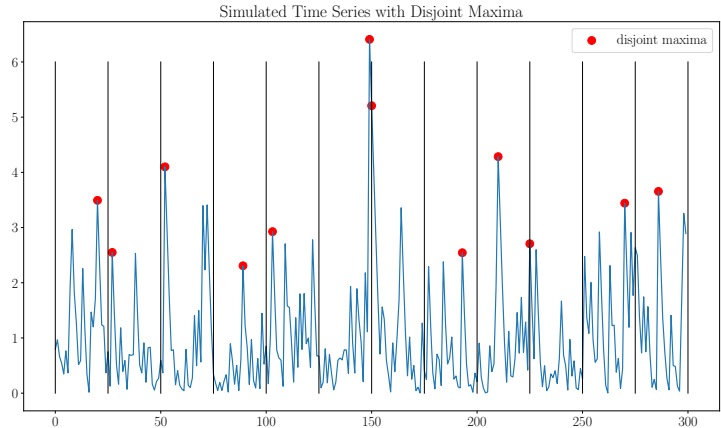


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- goal: estimate (γ, μ, σ) given small number of block maxima

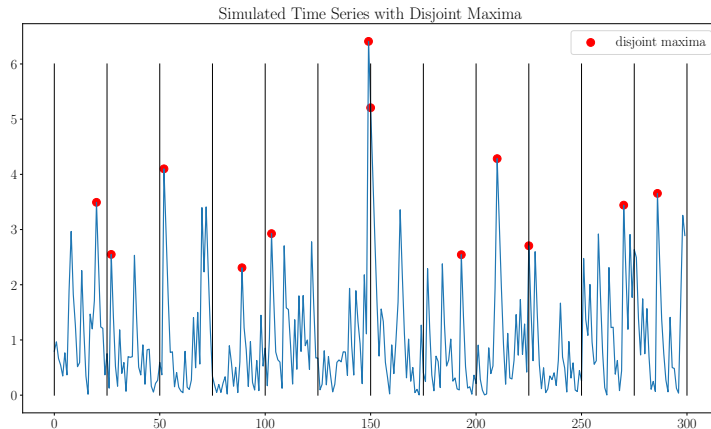


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Setting:

- $\xi_1, \dots, \xi_r$ are independent & identically distributed (iid)
- $M_r := \max\{\xi_1, \dots, \xi_r\}$

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Theorem (Fisher and Tippett 1928, Gnedenko 1943).

If there exist sequences $(a_r)_{r \in \mathbb{N}} \subset (0, \infty)$ and $(b_r)_{r \in \mathbb{N}} \subset \mathbb{R}$ such that $\mathbb{P}\left(\frac{M_r - b_r}{a_r} \leq x\right) \xrightarrow{\mathcal{D}} G(x)$ non-degenerate, then G is one of

$$G(x) = \begin{cases} \exp(-e^{-x}) & x \in \mathbb{R} \quad (\text{Gumbel distribution}), \\ \exp(-x^{-\alpha}) & \text{if } x > 0 \quad (\text{Fréchet distribution}), \\ \exp(-(-x)^{\alpha}) & \text{if } x \leq 0 \quad (\text{Weibull distribution}). \end{cases}$$

The GEV distribution

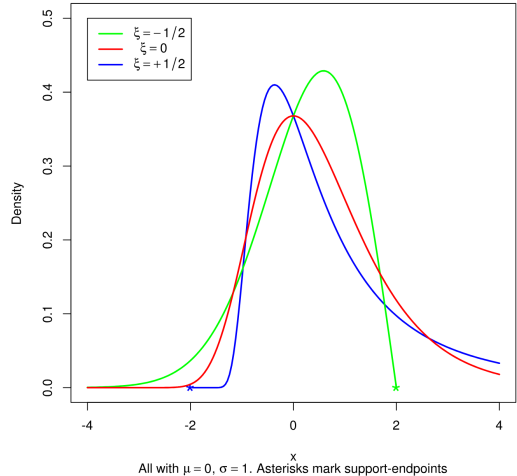
- Three cases (Gumbel, Fréchet, Weibull) summarizable by Generalized Extreme Value (GEV) distribution

$$G_{\text{GEV}(\vartheta)}(x) = \exp \left\{ - \left(1 + \xi \frac{x - \mu}{\sigma} \right)^{-1/\xi} \right\}$$

- $\vartheta = (\mu, \sigma, \xi)$
- Reparametrization: two-parametric Fréchet

$$G_{\text{Fréchet}(\vartheta)}(x) = \exp \left\{ - \left(\frac{x}{\sigma} \right)^{-\alpha} \right\}$$

Generalized extreme value densities



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 - Problem: disjoint block maxima make 'inefficient' use of data
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 - But why limit to maxima?
- Question: *How about using blockwise **Top-m** order statistics for GEV parameter estimation?*
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- We show **lack of consistency** in general, but demonstrate a correction procedure for Top-Two order statistics

Block Maxima Modeling: Maxima

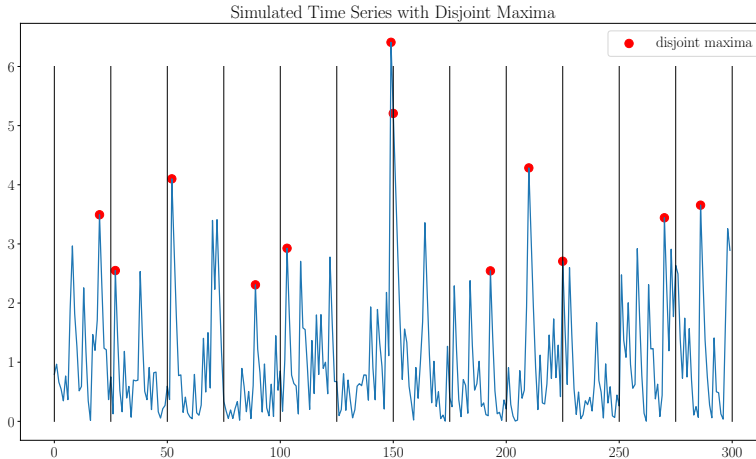


Figure 2: Sample of Disjoint Block Maxima. Distribution: GEV

Block Maxima Modeling: Top-Two

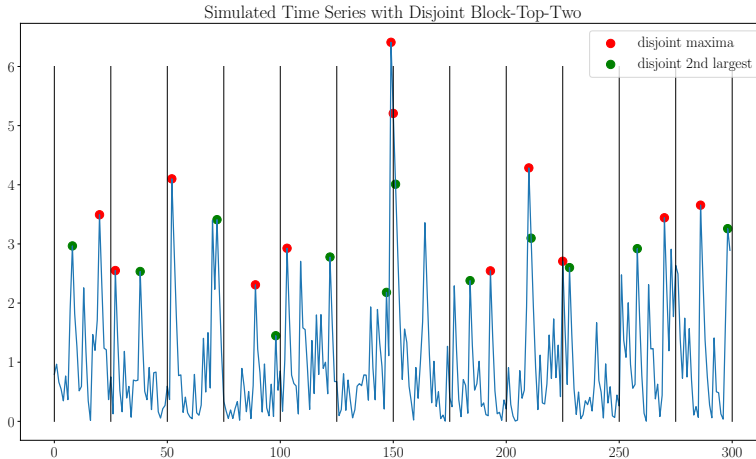


Figure 3: Sample of Disjoint Block Top-Two. Distribution: ???

Joint (limiting) Distribution of Top-Two

- Let $\xi_1, \dots, \xi_r \subset (\xi_t)_t$, (ξ_t) stationary time series, $M_r := \xi_{r:r}$, $S_r := \xi_{r-1:r}$
- If $M_r/\sigma_r \rightsquigarrow \text{Fréchet}(\alpha, 1) =: G_\alpha(\cdot)$, how does $(M_r/\sigma_r, S_r/\sigma_r)$ behave?

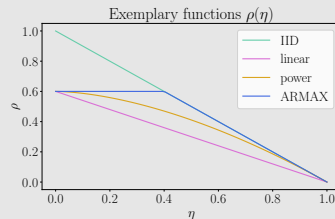
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Theorem (Welsch 1972)

$$\mathbb{P}(M_r/\sigma_r \leq x, S_r/\sigma_r \leq y) \rightsquigarrow H_{\rho, \alpha, \sigma}(x, y) = \begin{cases} G_\alpha(x) & y \geq x \\ G_\alpha(y) \left\{ 1 - \rho(\eta_\alpha(x, y)) \log G_\alpha(y) \right\} & x > y \end{cases}$$

- $\rho : [0, 1] \rightarrow [0, 1]$, $\eta_\alpha(x, y) = (y/x)^\alpha$
- $\rho_0 \cdot (1 - \eta) \leq \rho(\eta) \leq 1 - \eta$, concave, non-increasing
- ξ_t i.i.d. $\iff \rho(\eta) = 1 - \eta$
- density exists $\iff \int_0^1 \rho'(z) + z\rho''(z) \, dz = -1$



(Pseudo-) Maximum Likelihood Estimation of Welsch-distribution



(Pseudo-) Maximum Likelihood Estimation

- In most cases: H has **no λ^2 -density** $\rightsquigarrow$ no MLE possible
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- For some sample $(x_i, y_i)_{i=1, \dots, n}$ compute **Pseudo**-Maximum Likelihood:

$$\ell(\alpha, \sigma) = 2k \log \alpha + 2k\alpha \log \sigma - \sum_{i=1}^k \{(\alpha + 1) \log(x_i y_i) + \sigma^\alpha y_i^{-\alpha}\}. \quad (1)$$

- Think of x_i : as blockmaxima of ξ_t
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- Estimator $(\hat{\alpha}_n, \hat{\sigma}_n) := \arg \max_{\alpha, \sigma} \ell(\alpha, \sigma)$, similar to Weissman 1978; Smith 1986
- Valid if assumptions violated?

(S1) Sampling scheme

- Sample 'from the limit'
 - Assume $(x_i, y_i)_{i=1, \dots, k} \sim H_{\rho, \alpha_0, \sigma_n}$
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- ⇒ Goal: high-level results for limiting distribution

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(S2) Sampling scheme

- Sample from stationary time series $\xi_1, \dots, \xi_n \subset (\xi_t)_t$
 - Divide into $k = k_n$ blocks of size $r = r_n$
 - Let (x_i, y_i) be top-two order statistics of block i
- ↪ Goal: results on sample in DOA of $H_{\rho, \alpha_0, \sigma_n}$
- Plan: Conclude from **(S1)**

Lemma (Pseudo-MLE exists uniquely)

The MLE $(\hat{\alpha}_k, \hat{\sigma}_k)$ of scheme (S1) exists uniquely with $\hat{\alpha}_k$ as root of

$$\psi_k(\alpha) = 2\alpha^{-1} + 2 \cdot \left(\frac{1}{k} \sum_{i=1}^k y_i^{-\alpha} \right)^{-1} \cdot \frac{1}{k} \sum_{i=1}^k y_i^{-\alpha} \log y_i - \frac{1}{k} \sum_{i=1}^k \log x_i - \frac{1}{k} \sum_{i=1}^k \log y_i$$

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- Weak limit of $(\hat{\alpha}_k, \hat{\sigma}_k)$ as $k \rightarrow \infty$?

Asymptotics of $(\hat{\alpha}_k, \hat{\sigma}_k)$

- Consistency? i.e. $(\hat{\alpha}_k, \hat{\sigma}_k/\sigma_k) \rightsquigarrow (\alpha_0, 1)$?
- As $k \rightarrow \infty$: $\Psi_k(\alpha) \rightsquigarrow \Psi_{\rho, \alpha_0}(\alpha)$ for some limit function Ψ depending on $\rho_0 := \rho(0)$ and α_0
- Then $\hat{\alpha}_k = \text{Root}(\Psi_k(\alpha)) \rightsquigarrow \text{Root}(\Psi_{\rho, \alpha_0}(\alpha)) := \alpha_1$.

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In this situation, with " $\neq$ " holding unless $\rho_0 \in \{0, 1\}$,

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- Is there a way to make the estimator consistent?

- Can be shown: decomposition of α_1 into $\alpha_1 = \alpha_0 \cdot \varpi(\rho_0)$
- $\varpi(\rho_0)$ only depending on ρ_0 , implicitly defined as a root
- **Consistent Oracle:** $\tilde{\alpha}_k := \hat{\alpha}_k / \varpi$

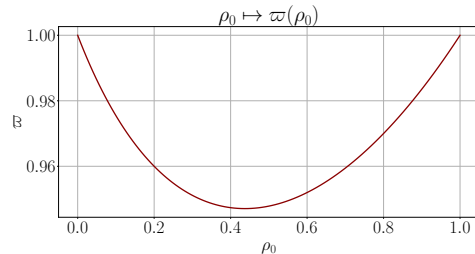


Figure 4: $\varpi : [0, 1] \rightarrow [0, 1]$ as function of ρ_0

Consistency correction

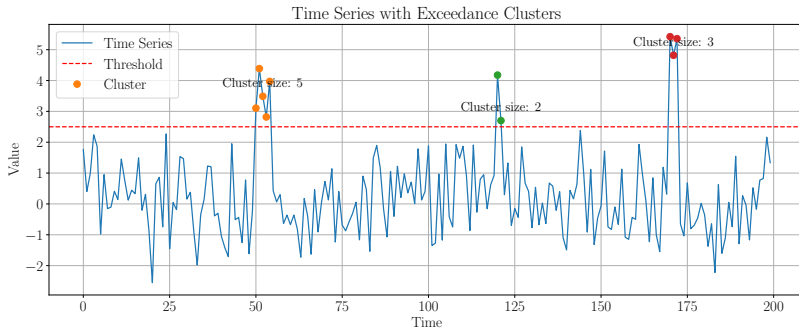
- **Oracle** $\tilde{\alpha}_k := \hat{\alpha}_k / \varpi$ depends on unknown $\varpi = \varpi(\rho_0)$
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- ρ_0 relates to *cluster size distribution* $\pi = (\pi(i))_{i \in \mathbb{N}}$ of *threshold exceedances* via $\rho_0 = \pi(1)$
- Some estimators for $\pi(1) = \rho_0$, available; we choose $\hat{\rho}_{0k}$ by Bücher and Jennessen [2022](#)
- modified σ_k estimator: $\tilde{\sigma}_k := \hat{\sigma}_k / \sigma_1(\hat{\rho}_{0k}, \alpha_0)$



Theorem (Consistent Estimator)

The modified estimator is consistent, i.e. $\begin{pmatrix} \tilde{\alpha}_n \\ \tilde{\sigma}_n/\sigma_n \end{pmatrix} \rightsquigarrow \begin{pmatrix} \alpha_0 \\ 1 \end{pmatrix}$.

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Theorem (General asymptotic distribution)

As $k \rightarrow \infty$, we have under regularity conditions,

$$\sqrt{k} \begin{pmatrix} \tilde{\alpha}_k - \alpha_0 \\ \tilde{\sigma}_k/\sigma_k - 1 \end{pmatrix} \rightsquigarrow \mathcal{N}_2(\mathbf{B}, \Sigma)$$

for some bias $\mathbf{B}$ and covariance Σ

(Pseudo-) MLE of Block Top-Two



(S2) Sampling Scheme

- Apply results to sample of block maxima in Fréchet-DOA
 - Sample size $k_n \rightarrow \infty$ for asymptotics
 - Block length $r_n \rightarrow \infty$ for DOA condition
 - total time series length: $n = r_n k_n$ for disjoint blocks

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 - Sample size $k_n \rightarrow \infty$ for asymptotics
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 - total time series length: $n = r_n k_n$ for disjoint blocks
- sample of interest: $\mathbf{Z}_n = \left(\begin{pmatrix} X_{n,1} \\ Y_{n,1} \end{pmatrix} \quad \cdots \quad \begin{pmatrix} X_{n,k_n} \\ Y_{n,k_n} \end{pmatrix} \right) \stackrel{\text{asym}}{\sim} H_{\rho, \alpha_0, \sigma_n}$
- Think of $\mathbf{Z}_n$ as sample of disjoint or sliding block top-two

Block Maxima Modeling: Top-Two

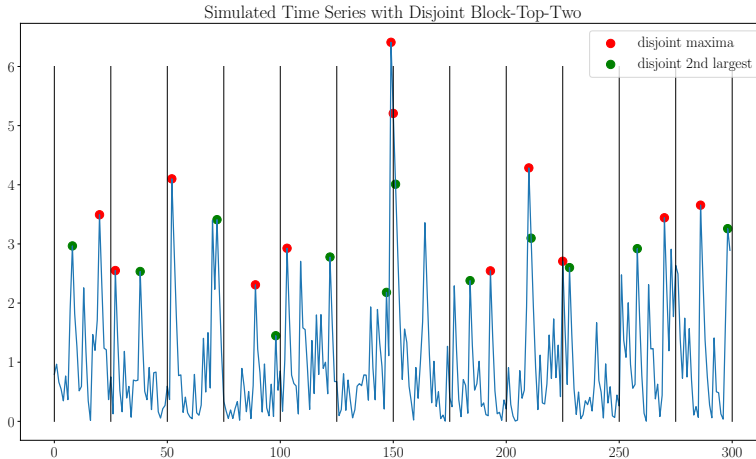


Figure 5: Sample of Disjoint Block Top-Two.

Block Maxima Modeling: Top-Two

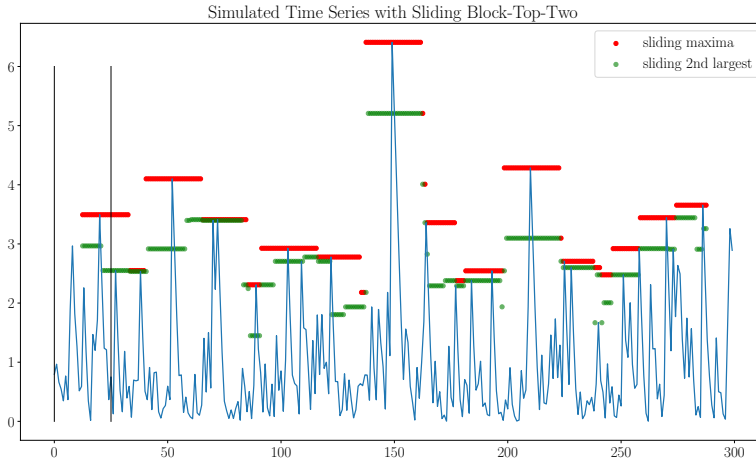


Figure 6: Sample of Sliding Block Top-Two

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Theorem (Asymptotic Normality of Block Maxima Estimators)

Under suitable assumptions (α -mixing, finite bias, regular variation of σ_r , ...)

$$\sqrt{n/r_n} \begin{pmatrix} \tilde{\alpha}_n^{(\text{mb})} - \alpha_0 \\ \tilde{\sigma}_n^{(\text{mb})} / \sigma_{r_n} - 1 \end{pmatrix} \rightsquigarrow \mathcal{N}_2(\mathbf{B}, \Sigma_{\rho, \alpha_0}^{(\text{mb})})$$

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Explicit terms for i.i.d. special case?

Special Scenario: Blockwise Top-Two of I.I.D Timeseries



- Recall DOA condition $\lim_{r \rightarrow \infty} F^r(a_r x) = \exp(-x^{-\alpha_0})$
- Equivalently: $-\log F$ is **regular varying** $\text{RV}(-\alpha_0)$, i.e.

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Condition [2nd Order Regular Variation]

$$\lim_{u \rightarrow \infty} \frac{1}{A(u)} \left(\frac{-\log F(ux)}{-\log F(u)} - x^{-\alpha_0} \right) = x^{-\alpha_0} \int_1^x y^{\tau-1} dy,$$

where $A : (0, \infty) \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$, $\lim_{u \rightarrow \infty} A(u) = 0$ captures the **speed of convergence**.

Special Case: I.I.D. (Disjoint Blocks)

Theorem (Asymptotic Normality for (2nd order τ -r.v.) I.I.D. time series)

$$\sqrt{k_n} \begin{pmatrix} \tilde{\alpha}_n - \alpha_0 \\ \tilde{\sigma}_n / \sigma_n - 1 \end{pmatrix} \rightsquigarrow \mathcal{N}_2 \left(M(\alpha_0) B(\alpha_0, \bar{\tau}), \Sigma_{\text{DB}}^{\text{TT}} \right), \quad n \rightarrow \infty,$$

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$$\text{with } M(\alpha_0) = \frac{6}{2\pi^2 - 3} \begin{pmatrix} \alpha_0^2 & \frac{3-2\gamma}{2}\alpha_0 & -\alpha_0^2 & -\alpha_0^2 \\ \frac{2\gamma-3}{2} & \frac{3-2\pi^2-3(3-2\gamma)^2}{12\alpha_0} & \frac{3-2\gamma}{2} & \frac{3-2\gamma}{2} \end{pmatrix}, \quad \bar{\tau} = \tau/\alpha_0,$$

$$\Sigma_{\text{DB}}^{\text{TT}} \approx \begin{pmatrix} 0.358\alpha_0^2 & -0.331 \\ -0.331 & 0.805/\alpha_0^2 \end{pmatrix}, \quad B(\alpha_0, \tau) = \frac{\lambda}{\tau\alpha_0^2} \begin{pmatrix} 2\gamma - 5 + \Gamma(3 - \tau) + \Gamma'(3 - \tau) \\ \alpha_0(2 - \Gamma(3 - \tau)) \\ \Gamma(2 - \tau) - 1 \\ \Gamma(1 - \tau) - 1 \end{pmatrix}.$$

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Theorem (Asymptotic Normality for (2nd order τ -r.v.) I.I.D. time series)

$$\sqrt{k_n} \begin{pmatrix} \tilde{\alpha}_n - \alpha_0 \\ \tilde{\sigma}_n / \sigma_n - 1 \end{pmatrix} \rightsquigarrow \mathcal{N}_2(M(\alpha_0)B(\alpha_0, \bar{\tau}), \Sigma_{\text{SB}}^{\text{TT}}), \quad n \rightarrow \infty,$$

$$\text{with } M(\alpha_0) = \frac{6}{2\pi^2 - 3} \begin{pmatrix} \alpha_0^2 & \frac{3-2\gamma}{2}\alpha_0 & -\alpha_0^2 & -\alpha_0^2 \\ \frac{2\gamma-3}{2} & \frac{3-2\pi^2-3(3-2\gamma)^2}{12\alpha_0} & \frac{3-2\gamma}{2} & \frac{3-2\gamma}{2} \end{pmatrix}, \quad \bar{\tau} = \tau/\alpha_0,$$

$$\Sigma_{\text{SB}}^{\text{TT}} \approx \begin{pmatrix} 0.304\alpha_0^2 & -0.338 \\ -0.338 & 0.774\alpha_0^2 \end{pmatrix}, \quad B(\alpha_0, \tau) = \frac{\lambda}{\tau\alpha_0^2} \begin{pmatrix} 2\gamma - 5 + \Gamma(3 - \tau) + \Gamma'(3 - \tau) \\ \alpha_0(2 - \Gamma(3 - \tau)) \\ \Gamma(2 - \tau) - 1 \\ \Gamma(1 - \tau) - 1 \end{pmatrix}.$$

Comparison of asymptotic covariances

- $TT \triangleq$ top-two, $\max \triangleq$ just maximum
- $\Sigma_{db}^{\max}$ and $\Sigma_{sb}^{\max}$ by Bücher and Segers 2018b and Bücher and Segers 2018a

$$\begin{aligned}\Sigma_{sb}^{TT} &\approx \begin{pmatrix} 0.304\alpha_0^2 & -0.338 \\ -0.338 & 0.774\alpha_0^2 \end{pmatrix} <_{\mathbb{L}} \Sigma_{db}^{TT} \approx \begin{pmatrix} 0.358\alpha_0^2 & -0.331 \\ -0.331 & 0.805/\alpha_0^2 \end{pmatrix} \\ &<_{\mathbb{L}} \Sigma_{sb}^{\max} \approx \begin{pmatrix} 0.495\alpha_0^2 & -0.324 \\ -0.324 & 1.958/\alpha_0^2 \end{pmatrix} \\ &<_{\mathbb{L}} \Sigma_{db}^{\max} \approx \begin{pmatrix} 0.608\alpha_0^2 & -0.257 \\ -0.257 & 1.109/\alpha_0^2 \end{pmatrix}\end{aligned}$$

- $<_{\mathbb{L}}$ denotes the LOEWNER-ordering

Simulation Results



Simulation: Shape Estimation

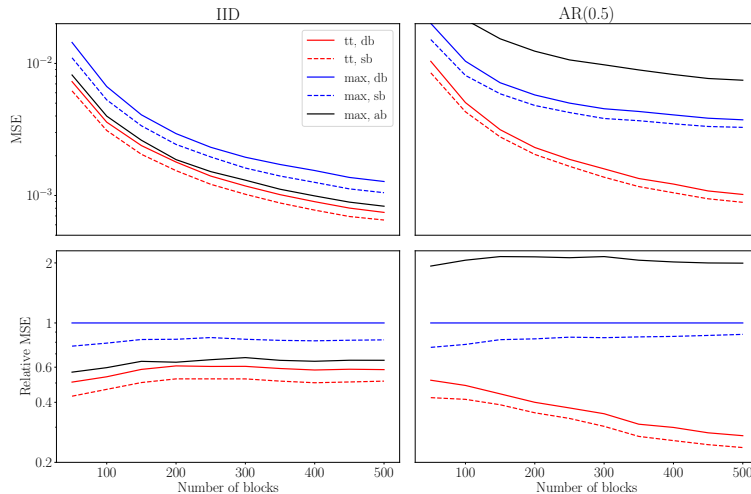


Figure 7: MSE and relative MSE, shape parameter α estimation.

Comparing our Top-Two (**tt** **mb**) estimators against Bücher and Segers 2018b (**max db**), Bücher and Segers 2018a (**max sb**) and Oorschot and Zhou 2020 (**max ab**)

Takeaway: **tt sb** is best

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Thank you!



Appendix



Top-Two (x_i, y_i) :

$$\psi_k(\alpha) = 2\alpha^{-1} + 2 \cdot \left(\frac{1}{k} \sum_{i=1}^k y_i^{-\alpha} \right)^{-1} \cdot \frac{1}{k} \sum_{i=1}^k y_i^{-\alpha} \log y_i - \frac{1}{k} \sum_{i=1}^k \log x_i - \frac{1}{k} \sum_{i=1}^k \log y_i$$

Top-Three (x_i, y_i, z_i) :

$$\psi_k(\alpha) = 2\alpha^{-1} + 2 \cdot \left(\frac{1}{k} \sum_{i=1}^k z_i^{-\alpha} \right)^{-1} \cdot \frac{1}{k} \sum_{i=1}^k z_i^{-\alpha} \log z_i - \frac{1}{k} \sum_{i=1}^k \log x_i - \frac{1}{k} \sum_{i=1}^k \log y_i - \frac{1}{k} \sum_{i=1}^k \log z_i$$

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Top-Three (x_i, y_i, z_i) :

$$\psi_k(\alpha) = 2\alpha^{-1} + 2 \cdot \left(\frac{1}{k} \sum_{i=1}^k z_i^{-\alpha} \right)^{-1} \cdot \frac{1}{k} \sum_{i=1}^k z_i^{-\alpha} \log z_i - \frac{1}{k} \sum_{i=1}^k \log x_i - \frac{1}{k} \sum_{i=1}^k \log y_i - \frac{1}{k} \sum_{i=1}^k \log z_i$$

- Needs moments of Top- r values
- Calculation not only involves $\rho_0 = \pi(1)$, but $\pi(1), \dots, \pi(r-1)$.

Top-Two (x_i, y_i) :

$$\psi_k(\alpha) = 2\alpha^{-1} + 2 \cdot \left(\frac{1}{k} \sum_{i=1}^k y_i^{-\alpha} \right)^{-1} \cdot \frac{1}{k} \sum_{i=1}^k y_i^{-\alpha} \log y_i - \frac{1}{k} \sum_{i=1}^k \log x_i - \frac{1}{k} \sum_{i=1}^k \log y_i$$

Top-Three (x_i, y_i, z_i) :

$$\psi_k(\alpha) = 2\alpha^{-1} + 2 \cdot \left(\frac{1}{k} \sum_{i=1}^k z_i^{-\alpha} \right)^{-1} \cdot \frac{1}{k} \sum_{i=1}^k z_i^{-\alpha} \log z_i - \frac{1}{k} \sum_{i=1}^k \log x_i - \frac{1}{k} \sum_{i=1}^k \log y_i - \frac{1}{k} \sum_{i=1}^k \log z_i$$

- Needs moments of Top- r values
- Calculation not only involves $\rho_0 = \pi(1)$, but $\pi(1), \dots, \pi(r-1)$.
- Rest should work in analogy
- Outlook: **How to choose r in practice?**

Simulation: Scale Estimation

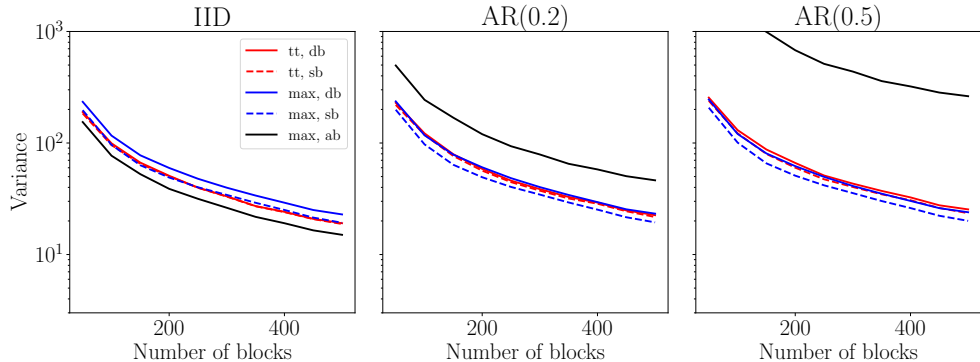


Figure 8: MSE under increasing temporal dependence, scale parameter σ estimation.

Takeaway: max sb is best

- Often interested in estimating (e.g.) [100-year]-return levels $RL(100)$
 - the value, which is exceeded once every 100 years (in expectation)

$$\begin{aligned} RL(T) &:= F^{\leftarrow}(1 - 1/T) = \inf\{x \in \mathbb{R} : F(x) \geq 1 - 1/T\} \\ &= \sigma(-\log(1 - 1/T))^{-1/\alpha} \end{aligned}$$

- being function of (α, σ) : $RL(T) = RL(T)(\alpha, \sigma) \rightsquigarrow$ need estimation of both parameters

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- being function of (α, σ) : $RL(T) = RL(T)(\alpha, \sigma) \rightsquigarrow$ need estimation of both parameters
- Estimate α via **tt mb** and σ via **max sb**
 - $\widehat{RL}(T) = RL(T)(\hat{\alpha}_{\text{tt mb}}, \hat{\sigma}_{\text{max sb}})$
- Does the resulting estimator combine 'best of two worlds'? **BOTWE?**

Simulation: Return Level Estimation

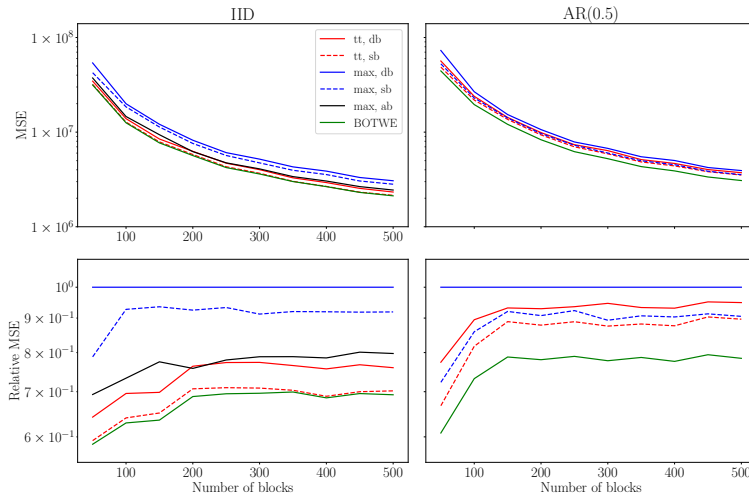


Figure 9: MSE and relative MSE, return level RL(100) estimation.

BOTWE: estimate α via **tt sb** and σ_r via **max sb** ('best of two worlds')

Takeaway:

BOTWE is indeed **BOTWE!**

Appendix: Fixed- n simulation study

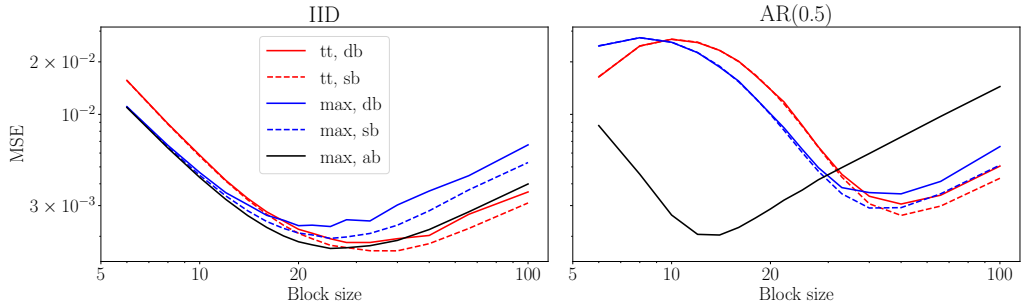


Figure 10: MSE for growing block size r and fixed total sample size n